

Threat-Model Yourself



BIG IDEA Security means deciding what matters to you, what could realistically go wrong, and choosing a few protections that fit your life. Specific beats scared.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R1 Asset Cards and Threat Cards (one set per group of 3 to 4), Workbook W1 per student, pens, a 2x2 grid on the board (Unlikely / Likely across, Small harm / Big harm up).

- ☐ Print and cut about 8 R1 sets.
- ☐ Draw the 2x2 grid and the four questions: Matters? Wrong? How bad / how likely? Smallest fix?
- ☐ Listen during the lesson for a card choice that sounds like a real situation; note it for a private check-in.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Say it word for word. “Raise a hand if you have ever locked your phone, locked a bike, or chosen who gets to see a story. That is security, and you already do it. You lock your bike more carefully than your water bottle, and you tell different people different things. Today we make that instinct deliberate. Security professionals call it a threat model, and it is four questions: What do I have that matters? What could go wrong? How bad and how likely? What is the smallest thing I can do about it? Be specific, and skip the paranoia.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Assets, Threats, Protections*

- 1 (1 min) Pick five assets.** Each student privately circles five things that matter to them on W1 (email, social account, photos, location and routine, money and game items, reputation, group chats, phone, health information, AI chat history). “Pick what matters to you.”
- 2 (3 min) Group threat sort.** Place each Threat Card (account takeover, scam message, lost device, oversharing friend, data broker or leak, someone who has your password, AI fake, pressure or blackmail, platform breach, location leak) on the 2x2 by likelihood and harm. “There is no answer key. Defend your placement in one sentence.”
- 3 (3 min) Protections.** Each student picks their top two threats and writes the smallest protection for each (a passkey for email, precise location off for two apps, a callback rule with family). It has to fit your actual life.
- 4 (1 min) One-line share.** Each group names one threat from the “likely and big harm” corner and one protection.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which threat did your group argue about most? What changed someone’s mind?”
- 2** “Why might two people in this room have totally different top threats?”
- 3** “When is ‘do nothing’ a reasonable answer to a threat?”

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Security is about knowing what to Pause over, what to Check, and who to Tell. Your threat model tells you where to aim them. On your Defense Plan page write: “The thing I most want to protect is _____, and my first move is _____.”

Hand signal: Hackles up? Your threat model maps where yours should go up (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Specific beats scared.”

EXIT TICKET “Name one asset you decided to protect first, and one thing you will do about it this week.” No names; tally the answers.

FUN BOOST Move-a-Card Challenge. After the sort, a neighboring group may move one card with a one-sentence argument; the original group accepts or defends. Points for reasoning, not winning.

LEVEL-UP Pre-Mortem. “It is six months from now and my top asset got compromised. What most likely happened, and what is the cheapest thing that would have stopped it?” Three lines.

DIFFERENTIATE Give a pre-filled example worksheet (a fictional teen, “Rowan”) to reshape, and the starter “The thing I most want to protect is ___ because ___.”

FAMILY CARD Ask: “What is one thing you want to protect first?” You do not need to be technical. Curiosity helps more than rules.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you...?” or “How could you...?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- “You should have told someone sooner.”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.